National Transportation Safety Board
Aviation Accident Final Report

Location:	Talladega, AL	**Accident Number:**	MIA08CA030
Date & Time:	12/18/2007, 0951 CST	**Registration:**	N2180E
Aircraft:	Cessna 172N	**Aircraft Damage:**	Substantial
Defining Event:		**Injuries:**	1 None
Flight Conducted Under:	Part 91: General Aviation - Personal		

Analysis

The student pilot stated that he entered left closed traffic for runway 21 at the Talladega Municipal Airport, Talladega, Alabama. He landed and started to prepare airplane for a touch-and-go. As he applied power he lost directional control of the airplane, went off the left side of the runway, and collided with a tree. The student pilot did not report any mechanical or flight control anomalies with the airplane.

Probable Cause and Findings

The National Transportation Safety Board determines the probable cause(s) of this accident to be: The pilot's failure to maintain directional control of the airplane.

Findings

Occurrence #1: LOSS OF CONTROL - ON GROUND/WATER
Phase of Operation: LANDING - ROLL

Findings
1. (C) DIRECTIONAL CONTROL - NOT MAINTAINED - PILOT IN COMMAND

Occurrence #2: IN FLIGHT COLLISION WITH OBJECT
Phase of Operation: LANDING - ROLL

Findings
2. OBJECT - TREE(S)

Factual Information

Student Pilot Information

Certificate:	Student	**Age:**	47, Male
Airplane Rating(s):	Single-engine Land	**Seat Occupied:**	Left
Other Aircraft Rating(s):	None	**Restraint Used:**	Seatbelt, Shoulder harness
Instrument Rating(s):	None	**Second Pilot Present:**	No
Instructor Rating(s):	None	**Toxicology Performed:**	No
Medical Certification:	Class 3 None	**Last FAA Medical Exam:**	06/01/2007
Occupational Pilot:		**Last Flight Review or Equivalent:**	
Flight Time:	37 hours (Total, all aircraft), 37 hours (Total, this make and model), 10 hours (Pilot In Command, all aircraft), 24 hours (Last 90 days, all aircraft), 14 hours (Last 30 days, all aircraft)		

Aircraft and Owner/Operator Information

Aircraft Make:	Cessna	**Registration:**	N2180E
Model/Series:	172N	**Aircraft Category:**	Airplane
Year of Manufacture:		**Amateur Built:**	No
Airworthiness Certificate:	Normal	**Serial Number:**	172-71159
Landing Gear Type:	Tricycle	**Seats:**	4
Date/Type of Last Inspection:	07/01/2007, Annual	**Certified Max Gross Wt.:**	2300 lbs
Time Since Last Inspection:	0 Hours	**Engines:**	1 Reciprocating
Airframe Total Time:	4937 Hours at time of accident	**Engine Manufacturer:**	Lycoming
ELT:	Installed, not activated	**Engine Model/Series:**	O-320-HAD
Registered Owner:	Redstone Arsenal Flying Activity	**Rated Power:**	160 hp
Operator:	Redstone Arsenal Flying Activity	**Operating Certificate(s) Held:**	None

Meteorological Information and Flight Plan

Conditions at Accident Site:	Visual Conditions	**Condition of Light:**	Day
Observation Facility, Elevation:	KAFN, 509 ft msl	**Distance from Accident Site:**	0 Nautical Miles
Observation Time:	0855 CST	**Direction from Accident Site:**	0°
Lowest Cloud Condition:	Clear	**Visibility**	10 Miles
Lowest Ceiling:	None	**Visibility (RVR):**	
Wind Speed/Gusts:	8 knots /	**Turbulence Type Forecast/Actual:**	/
Wind Direction:	170°	**Turbulence Severity Forecast/Actual:**	/
Altimeter Setting:	30.2 inches Hg	**Temperature/Dew Point:**	5°C / 15°C
Precipitation and Obscuration:	No Obscuration; No Precipitation		
Departure Point:	Talladega, AL (HUA)	**Type of Flight Plan Filed:**	None
Destination:	JAFFREY, NH (AFN)	**Type of Clearance:**	None
Departure Time:	0855 CST	**Type of Airspace:**	

Airport Information

Airport:	TALLADEGA MUNI (ASN)	**Runway Surface Type:**	Asphalt
Airport Elevation:	529 ft	**Runway Surface Condition:**	Dry
Runway Used:	21	**IFR Approach:**	Visual
Runway Length/Width:	6001 ft / 100 ft	**VFR Approach/Landing:**	Full Stop

Wreckage and Impact Information

Crew Injuries:	1 None	**Aircraft Damage:**	Substantial
Passenger Injuries:	N/A	**Aircraft Fire:**	None
Ground Injuries:	N/A	**Aircraft Explosion:**	None
Total Injuries:	1 None	**Latitude, Longitude:**	33.568611, -86.050556

Administrative Information

Investigator In Charge (IIC):	Eric H Alleyne	**Report Date:**	03/31/2008
Additional Participating Persons:	James West; Birmingham FSDO-09; Birmingham, AL		
Publish Date:			
Note:	This accident report documents the factual circumstances of this accident as described to the NTSB.		
Investigation Docket:	NTSB accident and incident dockets serve as permanent archival information for the NTSB's investigations. Dockets released prior to June 1, 2009 are publicly available from the NTSB's Record Management Division at pubinq@ntsb.gov, or at 800-877-6799. Dockets released after this date are available at http://dms.ntsb.gov/pubdms/.		

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The Independent Safety Board Act, as codified at 49 U.S.C. Section 1154(b), precludes the admission into evidence or use of any part of an NTSB report related to an incident or accident in a civil action for damages resulting from a matter mentioned in the report. A factual report that may be admissible under 49 U.S.C. § 1154(b) is available here.